45 Ways to Make Money Online in Canada (2026): Complete Guide to Side Hustles and Full-Time Gigs

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Quick Answer: The best ways to make money online in Canada include completing paid surveys, selling possessions on marketplaces, freelancing on platforms like Upwork and Fiverr, starting a blog or YouTube channel, dropshipping, affiliate marketing, teaching English online, and renting out your home or parking space. The easiest ways to earn money online in Canada include filling out surveys on Swagbucks and Prime Opinion, taking advantage of banking sign-up bonuses, and selling unused items on Facebook Marketplace or Kijiji. Legitimate online income opportunities pay via PayPal, Interac e-Transfer, direct deposit, or gift cards, and can range from a few dollars per week to a full-time income depending on the method.

Introduction: How Canadians Are Earning Money Online in 2026

Are you looking to earn some extra cash or maybe even contemplating a career change? There are many ways to make money online in Canada, and while some will only help you get a little extra pocket money, others have the potential to be quite lucrative.

In this guide, we'll show you how to make money online in Canada and what you need to do to get started. From quick side hustles that pay within days to long-term business opportunities that can replace your full-time income, there's an option for every skill level, schedule, and financial goal.

The digital economy has transformed how Canadians work and earn. Whether you're a student looking for flexible income, a parent wanting to work from home, a retiree seeking supplemental earnings, or a professional considering a career pivot, the opportunities are more accessible than ever before.

Top Picks at a Glance

Play Games & Take Surveys

Freecash

Get a $10 sign-up bonus

Exclusive: Get a $40 reward from Finder

Make average of $300 per offer

Access a variety of tasks

Best for Mobile

Testerup

Earn up to $800 through offers

No limit on how much you play games or complete surveys

Earn money while playing games

Paid Surveys

LEO (Leger Opinion)

Earn up to $100 per month in rewards

Finder readers receive 2,000 LEO welcome bonus points

Free, user-friendly, and secure app and website

1. *Fill Out Surveys*

Online surveys are often the first port of call for Canadians looking for ways to earn money online. There are a host of sites and apps in Canada where you can earn cash or points by completing online surveys and questionnaires. Popular options include LEO, Swagbucks, Prime Opinion and Branded Surveys. Sites like Swagbucks offer options to make money beyond completing surveys; you can also play games, earn cashback on online purchases and more.

The best part is that it's easy to get started and earn straight away. If the site pays cash, you can withdraw funds to your bank account once you've earned a specified minimum. If the site pays in points, they're usually redeemable for gift cards and other rewards.

Tips to Succeed

Sign up for multiple survey platforms to increase opportunities

Complete your profile thoroughly for better survey matches

Check in daily for new survey invitations

Consider higher-paying interview and product-testing surveys

Cash out regularly to avoid points expiration

Dive deeper: $40 Finder | Freecash Promotion

1. *Take Advantage of Banking Sign-Up Offers*

Many banks in Canada offer cash bonuses or promotional interest rates when you sign up for a new account. In the case of a cash bonus, banks will essentially give you money—sometimes hundreds of dollars—for opening an account with them.

To qualify for these types of offers, you typically have to open an account (which you can do online in a few minutes), set up direct deposits for a set amount of time and the cash bonus will be automatically deposited into your account. It's often as simple as that.

Current Sign-Up Offers

Offer Reward Key Features

BMO Performance Chequing Account $175 Reward Earn a $900 welcome bonus, unlimited free transactions, $0 Interac e-Transfers, monthly fee waived on $4,000+ balance

Coast Capital Unlimited Chequing Account Welcome bonus available Earn a $600 welcome bonus, monthly fee waived, no transaction fees, $0 Interac e-Transfers, free cheque book

EQ Bank Personal Account 2.75% interest for 12 months No monthly account fee, free ATM withdrawals across Canada, no transaction fees, no e-Transfer fees

Tips to Succeed

Read the terms carefully to understand qualifying requirements

Set up direct deposits immediately to start the qualifying period

Keep the account open for the required minimum period

Consider switching banks periodically to take advantage of new offers

Check out our full guide to new bank account offers to learn more

1. *Earn Cash Rewards from Comparison Sites*

Switching bank accounts is not your only way to earn a bonus. Financial comparison sites offer cash rewards for taking specific actions, including signing up for a new credit card, applying to a lender or signing up with a get-paid-to platform. This is in addition to any welcome bonuses the provider might offer.

These platforms partner with financial institutions and service providers to promote their products. When you complete a qualifying action through the comparison site, you receive a cash bonus directly from the platform. The bonus is separate from any welcome offer the provider itself may be offering, meaning you can potentially earn twice.

Tips to Succeed

Compare offers across multiple comparison sites before applying

Stack comparison site rewards with provider welcome bonuses

Read terms carefully to understand qualifying requirements

Time your applications to maximize promotional periods

1. *Sell Your Possessions*

If you've got some unused items lying around the house that you no longer need, make some extra cash by selling them on an online marketplace. Sporting equipment, jewelry, games consoles, furniture, board games, books—the list of stuff you can sell online is just about endless.

Facebook Marketplace, Kijiji, eBay and Craigslist are just some of your options, and it's easy to post listings via mobile apps or online.

Tips to Succeed

Take clear, well-lit photos from multiple angles

Write detailed descriptions including condition and dimensions

Price competitively by researching similar listings

Respond promptly to inquiries

Consider bundling items for higher-value sales

1. *Sell Your Car*

That's right—you don't have to visit a dealership in person and worry about haggling with a sleazy salesman to sell your car. These days, online dealers like Clutch and Canada Drives make it easy to sell vehicles online. All you have to do is provide your vehicle details online to get an offer to buy your car, and if you're happy with the price, you can drive it to a nearby drop-off location to complete the sale.

Alternatively, you can list your car for sale on classifieds sites like AutoTrader, Kijiji and Facebook Marketplace. Selling privately may help you get a better price for your car, but it's less convenient and you'll need to deal with lowballers.

Tips to Succeed

Get multiple quotes from online dealers before deciding

Clean and detail your car before taking photos

Gather maintenance records to demonstrate care

Be prepared to negotiate when selling privately

Consider timing—spring and summer often yield better prices

Dive deeper: Popular sites to sell a used car online

1. *Sell Handmade Items*

If you're a crafty person, you can put your skills to work to help you make money online. Sites like Etsy

make it easy to sell handmade items like jewelry, home decor, personalized gifts and clothes online. Alternatively, you can try connecting with buyers on other platforms like Instagram and Facebook Marketplace.

Tips to Succeed

Find a niche that sets your products apart

Invest in quality product photography

Write compelling product descriptions that tell a story

Offer customization options for higher prices

Build a social media following to drive traffic to your shop

1. *Sell Custom Items Using Print-on-Demand Websites*

Print-on-demand websites like RedBubble, Printful and Printify allow you to get your own custom artwork on clothing, cushions, tote bags, mugs and more. You create your product designs and upload them to your own store or an online marketplace. When a buyer purchases one of your items, the print-on-demand service will then take care of printing and shipping it to them.

Tips to Succeed

Focus on designs that appeal to specific niches

Use trending topics and seasonal themes

Optimize your product titles and tags for search

Promote your designs on social media

Consider multiple product types for each design

1. *Dropshipping*

Selling print-on-demand items is a form of dropshipping. With this approach, you set up an online store to sell your products—you could sell clothing, pet supplies, home decor, baby products or just about anything—but you don't hold any inventory or ship products. That side of the business is taken care of by the manufacturer, who ships items directly to buyers.

Tips to Succeed

Research profitable niches with consistent demand

Build a professional-looking e-commerce website

Focus on customer service to build repeat business

Use social media advertising to drive traffic

Monitor suppliers for quality and shipping times

1. *Create and Sell Printables*

From greeting cards to diaries and planners, printables are digital products designed to be purchased and then physically printed out. Use design software like Canva to create your own unique range of custom designs, then sell them on a platform like Etsy or through your own online store.

Tips to Succeed

Identify gaps in the market by reading customer reviews

Create bundles to increase average order value

Offer free samples to build your email list

Use seasonal and holiday themes for timely sales

Update your product line regularly

Related: How to make money on Canva

1. *Start a Blog*

Got a head full of opinions and ideas you need to share with the world? You could turn your musings into money by starting a blog. All you have to do is find your niche, choose a blogging platform and hosting platform, design your blog and start posting.

Success Story: Frugal Mom Eh!

Ontario-based Elizabeth Lampman left her IT career behind to become a stay-at-home mom and professional blogger. In 2012 she started Frugal Mom Eh!, a lifestyle blog dedicated to delicious family meal ideas and fun crafts. Elizabeth's recipes and crafts have been featured in a host of reputable websites and publications, from USA Today and Good Housekeeping to BuzzFeed, and her blog allows her to make money from income streams like affiliate marketing and brand partnerships.

Tips to Succeed

Choose a profitable niche with dedicated advertisers

Invest in quality hosting and a professional theme

Publish consistently to build your audience

Monetize through ads, affiliate marketing, and sponsored posts

Build an email list from day one

Related: How to start a blog and make money

1. *Write Books or Ebooks*

From a romance novel or suspense thriller to a cookbook or a health and fitness instructional, put your passion for the written word into action and write a book. You can then pitch it to publishers or use a self-publishing service, then market it to your target audience to generate sales.

Tips to Succeed

Research popular genres and topics in your niche

Invest in professional editing and cover design

Build an author platform through social media

Price competitively, especially for ebooks

Consider series for recurring revenue

1. *Create Content with AI*

You might be surprised by the sheer range and quality of AI content creation tools now available. From brainstorming ideas for marketing campaigns to generating social media graphics, creating images, editing videos and writing copy, AI tools open up a world of creative possibilities. This in turn lets you access a range of money-making opportunities.

Tips to Succeed

Master popular AI tools like ChatGPT, Midjourney, and Canva AI

Offer AI-assisted services to businesses

Use AI to speed up your own content creation

Stay updated on new AI tools and capabilities

Combine AI efficiency with human creativity

Dive deeper: AI apps to make money

1. *Train AI*

There are companies that pay you to help refine their AI models so they can produce better responses. Examples include DataAnnotation, Alignerr and CrowdGen. Tasks vary based on your skills, such as labelling images or text, coding, fact-checking and evaluating AI answers.

Tips to Succeed

Highlight specialized skills like coding or writing

Complete qualification tests to access higher-paying tasks

Maintain high accuracy to receive more work

Work consistently to build your reputation

Consider multiple platforms for steady income

Dive deeper: Ways to make money with AI

1. *Affiliate Marketing*

Affiliate marketing involves promoting another company's products or services in return for a commission. Essentially, you create your own website to direct customers to the company's website or marketplace product listings, where they will hopefully make a purchase. You might be paid every time a customer clicks on the link to the provider's website, or you may only be paid if they make a purchase.

Tips to Succeed

Choose products you genuinely use and believe in

Build a content site around your chosen niche

Focus on SEO to drive organic traffic

Diversify across multiple affiliate programs

Track your results and optimize what works

1. *Livestream*

Playing video games, cooking, broadcasting sports events or showcasing your daily life—livestreaming provides a unique and interactive experience to share with your audience. Deliver regular, high-quality content to build a loyal following in your chosen niche, and then you may be able to turn it into a money-making opportunity through donations from viewers, partnering with brands, selling subscriptions for exclusive content and more.

Success Story: Nick Eh 30

Popular streamer and YouTuber Nick Eh 30, aka Nicholas Amyoony, is living out many a kid's dream job. This Nova Scotian started making gaming videos as a university student, launching his Nick Eh 30 YouTube channel in late 2014. By 2017 he had abandoned his studies and become a professional streamer, and his Fortnite videos have seen him amass 5.7 million followers on Twitch.

Tips to Succeed

Choose a niche you're passionate about

Stream consistently on a set schedule

Engage with your chat to build community

Invest in quality audio and video equipment

Diversify income through donations, subscriptions, and sponsorships

1. *Become an Online Fitness Instructor*

Whether you're an experienced personal trainer or just someone who loves staying in shape, you could offer personal training classes online. You can offer tailored fitness classes to clients in the privacy of their own home, and you can also create and sell your own workout plans and fitness courses online.

Success Story: Janelle Hill

Janelle Hill's athletic journey started in figure skating, a sport she pursued with passion in her younger years. And when this always active Canadian started hitting the gym in 2015, she found a passion for helping people get stronger. She began sharing workout videos on Instagram, while at the same time getting certified as a personal trainer, pursuing a bachelor of kinesiology and still skating multiple times a week. Today, she has close to 26,000 Instagram followers and offers in-person and online fitness coaching through her website, gymwithjan.com.

Tips to Succeed

Get certified to build credibility

Create a content strategy for social media

Offer free content to attract potential clients

Build a professional website with booking capability

Consider group programs for scalable income

1. *Make YouTube Videos*

Got a special skill or insight that others might be interested in learning or hearing about? You might be surprised by what people are willing to watch on YouTube. You could film yourself tackling competitive eating challenges like BeardMeatsFood, playing Minecraft like Unspeakable, share fitness tips, show people how to do common DIY jobs around the house or just about anything else you can imagine.

If your videos get enough views, you can earn money from advertising revenue, sell merch to your subscribers and monetize your channel in a handful of other ways. Learn more about starting a YouTube channel.

Tips to Succeed

Choose a niche with loyal, engaged viewers

Invest in decent camera and audio equipment

Study successful channels in your niche

Publish consistently and optimize thumbnails

Diversify income beyond ad revenue

1. *Narrate Audiobooks*

If you're blessed with an excellent voice and the sort of acting chops required to inject life into content you read, audiobook narration could be your perfect side hustle. Once you've built a portfolio of work, you can look for narration jobs on platforms like ACX, Audible, Voquent and Voices.

Success Story: Tiffany Ayalik

An Inuit actor and performer from the Northwest Territories, Tiffany Ayalik is no stranger to the stage. The talented theatre and fine arts student started acting in film and TV, also dabbling in voiceover work, but it wasn't until COVID hit that she started getting work narrating audiobooks. The training she received in the theatre stands her in good stead as she brings characters to life in works like Forever Birchwood, a YA novel by author Danielle Daniel.

Tips to Succeed

Invest in a quality microphone and recording space

Practice different character voices and accents

Build a portfolio with short samples

Audition regularly on multiple platforms

Consider narrating for indie authors to build experience

1. ***Start a Podcast***

Sports, true crime, children's stories, money management tips, parenting, you name it—browse Spotify or Apple Podcasts and you'll find podcasts covering just about every topic under the sun. So, if you have a special passion in life or specialist knowledge you'd like to share, why not start your own podcast?

Tips to Succeed

Choose a niche with a dedicated listener base

Invest in quality microphones and editing software

Publish on a consistent schedule

Promote episodes on social media

Monetize through sponsorships, ads, and premium content

1. ***Become a Social Media Influencer***

If your social media game is strong, why not use your skills to earn income as an "influencer"? Influencer marketing is where you build a large following among a niche audience, which could be anything from beauty and self-care to improving your golf game, until brands want to pay you to promote their products. From Instagram and TikTok to YouTube, Twitch and a host of other platforms, there are many different ways to engage with your audience.

Tips to Succeed

Choose a specific niche to build authority

Post consistently and engage with your audience

Create high-quality content that provides value

Reach out to brands for partnerships

Consider a media kit to attract sponsorships

1. ***Provide Transcription Services***

Transcribers take audio or video content and convert it into text, and they're in high demand in legal, medical and media industries. If you're a fast and accurate typist—aim for at least 50 words per minute—working as a transcriptionist could be a lucrative side hustle. Check out sites like Rev and TranscribeMe to get started.

Tips to Succeed

Develop specialized knowledge in legal or medical transcription

Invest in quality headphones and software

Maintain high accuracy to receive better-paying assignments

Work efficiently to maximize hourly earnings

Build relationships with regular clients

1. ***Become an Amazon Mechanical Turk Worker***

Amazon Mechanical Turk (MTurk) is an online marketplace where people and businesses can outsource various jobs. Sign up as an MTurk worker and you can complete tasks like analyzing images, processing data, answering surveys, transcribing audio content and a whole lot more.

Tips to Succeed

Complete qualification tests to unlock higher-paying tasks

Focus on tasks from requesters with good ratings

Work efficiently to maximize earnings

Use scripts to automate repetitive tasks

Check for new tasks regularly

1. *Work as a Freelancer*

Want to work from home and be your own boss? Sites like Upwork, Fiverr and Freelancer let you make money online in Canada by helping you connect with people and companies who need professional services.

You can freelance full-time or as a side hustle to earn some extra cash. There's work out there for writers, graphic designers, translators, voiceover artists, web designers, programmers, SEO specialists, bookkeepers and a range of other professionals, so search for work opportunities based on your skill set.

Tips to Succeed

Create a professional profile highlighting your skills

Start with competitive rates to build reviews

Deliver high-quality work on time

Communicate clearly with clients

Gradually increase your rates as you gain experience

Get Paid Twice for Your Financial Moves

Earn $40–$175+ when you sign up for select financial products through our free rewards program. Plus, keep 100% of the provider's welcome bonus.

Discover deals

1. *Become a Social Media Consultant*

Terrific at TikTok? In demand on Insta? Use your savvy social media skills to segue into a lucrative side hustle or potentially a new career. There are plenty of businesses and individuals out there that need a lot of help upping their social game, increasing user engagement and generating more sales. And that's where a social media consultant like you can make money by sharing skills and expertise.

Tips to Succeed

Build your own social media presence first

Document your results with metrics

Offer packages at different price points

Stay updated on platform changes and trends

Specialize in a specific industry or platform

1. *Work as a Virtual Assistant*

In the same vein as becoming a freelancer, working remotely as a virtual assistant allows you to make money online in Canada. It's free to offer your services on sites like Upwork, and you can get paid to help clients with jobs like office admin, social media management, responding to emails, scheduling appointments and much more.

Tips to Succeed

Identify your strongest administrative skills

Offer a range of services to attract more clients

Be responsive and reliable

Use project management tools to stay organized

Consider specializing in a specific industry

1. ***Teach English***

Sites like Cambly, SkimaTalk and Preply make it easy to connect with students around the world who want to learn English. In some cases, you don't even need to be an accredited language teacher, just a native English speaker. The idea is to teach your students English simply by engaging them in conversation.

Tips to Succeed

Get TEFL certification to access better-paying platforms

Create a welcoming, encouraging atmosphere

Prepare conversation topics and materials

Be consistent with your availability

Build relationships with regular students

1. ***Create Online Courses***

Are you an expert in your field? Do you have specialist knowledge about a specific niche, like photography, digital marketing, starting a business or playing guitar? If so, you could design, create and sell your own courses online. Platforms like Teachable, Udemy, Thinkific and Kajabi offer the tools you need to share your educational materials with a wide audience.

Tips to Succeed

Validate demand before creating your course

Invest in quality video and audio production

Provide actionable, practical content

Price based on value, not length

Market through email and social media

1. ***Become an Online Tutor***

Maybe you're a mathematics or English teacher looking for some extra income? Perhaps you're an experienced guitarist who wants to go down the teaching route? Whatever the case may be, you can make money online by offering your services as a tutor. Whether on sites like Upwork and Fiverr or on specific tutoring platforms, offering your expert services provides a flexible way to earn extra income.

Tips to Succeed

Identify subjects you can teach effectively

Create a profile highlighting your qualifications

Offer a free introductory session

Be patient and adapt to different learning styles

Collect testimonials from satisfied students

1. ***Start a Subscription Box Business***

Would you love to receive a box of specially curated goodies each month? It could be luxe skincare items, artisan coffee, pet toys and treats, or maybe handpicked novels from your favourite genre. If you've got an idea that will stand out from the crowd, create your own monthly (or maybe bi-monthly or quarterly) gift box package and start selling subscriptions.

Success Story: Lit Love

In February 2022, as the world was still coming to terms with the COVID pandemic, the BC-based Lit Love book subscription box was born. Founder Deanna had previously tried her luck with a book subscription box business five to six years before, but decided the time was right to give it another go.

Lit Love specializes in thoughtfully curated boxes for people who love to read. Each month, subscribers get

to choose a new-release book from several genres, and the reading material is shipped with a selection of delicious snacks, bath and body products for a little pampering, and home essentials.

Tips to Succeed

Choose a niche with passionate potential subscribers

Source quality products at competitive prices

Create attractive packaging that photographs well

Build anticipation through social media

Offer flexible subscription options

Must read: Weird or creative ways to make money

1. *Develop a Mobile App*

Have you got an idea for an app that could help make people's lives easier or better in some way? Maybe it's an app to guide people on a weight loss journey, to help them manage their weekly budget, or to connect with others in the local community. You don't need to be a genius developer to create your own app, promote it and make it available to download on the App Store and Google Play.

Tips to Succeed

Validate your idea with potential users first

Start with a minimum viable product (MVP)

Focus on solving a specific problem well

Monetize through ads, subscriptions, or one-time purchases

Update regularly based on user feedback

1. *Become a Video Game Tester*

If you're a keen gamer, this might sound like your dream job. There are several legit platforms out there that will pay you for testing PC and mobile games before they're released and providing feedback to the developers. Platforms like Game Tester, Antidote and PlaytestCloud are worth checking out.

Tips to Succeed

Sign up for multiple testing platforms

Provide detailed, constructive feedback

Be reliable and meet deadlines

Develop skills in different game genres

Consider QA testing as a career path

1. *Rent Out Your Home*

Airbnb is one of those sites that needs no introduction, providing a way to make money online in Canada by renting out a space to guests looking for somewhere to stay. It's free to list your space on Airbnb, allowing you to earn extra cash using an asset you already own.

Alternatively, you could rent out your home (or a part of your home) for use as a private event space or for film and photo shoots using sites like Tagvenue, Giggster and Peerspace.

Tips to Succeed

Invest in quality photos and furnishings

Respond quickly to booking inquiries

Provide excellent hospitality to earn good reviews

Understand local regulations and tax requirements

Consider professional cleaning between guests

1. *Rent Out Your Parking Space*

In major cities like Toronto and Vancouver, parking is at a premium. So, if you live in a popular area close to the city centre and you have a parking space you don't use, you can earn a little extra income by renting it out on sites like clicknpark, Parkify and SpotHero. It's quick and easy to do, requiring minimal time or effort on your part.

Tips to Succeed

Price competitively based on location and demand

Take clear photos of the space

Respond promptly to inquiries

Consider monthly rentals for steady income

Ensure you have the right to sublet the space

1. *Sell Domain Names*

The concept behind "flipping" domain names is to buy a domain name at a low price and sell it for a much higher price. The trick is, of course, to be able to recognize domains that will be highly sought-after and that you could potentially sell for a profit.

Tips to Succeed

Research trending keywords and industries

Use tools to find expired domains with value

Focus on short, memorable, keyword-rich names

List on multiple marketplaces

Be patient—the right buyer may take time

1. *Enter Competitions*

Have you ever heard of "compers"? These serial competition participants devote a whole lot of time to entering competitions online, and some of them have a surprising amount of success. It's free to do and can take up as much or as little time as you want.

Tips to Succeed

Create a dedicated email for competition entries

Use a spreadsheet to track entered competitions

Focus on competitions with prizes you actually want

Enter consistently to increase your chances

Join online communities to find new opportunities

1. *Shop on Cashback Websites*

Cashback apps and websites like Rakuten, Swagbucks and Great Canadian Rebates offer a simple way to get more money in your bank account. By doing your regular shopping through these platforms at partner retailers, you can earn a certain percentage cashback on all your purchases. Examples of retailers include Best Buy, Sephora and Canadian Tire.

Tips to Succeed

Install browser extensions for automatic cashback notifications

Stack cashback with credit card rewards

Check for higher cashback rates during promotions

Use cashback sites for all online shopping

Cash out regularly to avoid expiration

1. *Work as a Remote Customer Service Rep*

Put your people skills into action by working as a remote customer service rep. You might be surprised by the number of companies that offer jobs for personable people who can answer calls and manage online chats—all from home. You might also be able to increase your chance of getting work if you're bilingual.

Companies advertise jobs directly on sites like Indeed. Or, you could look for work on freelancer sites like Upwork or specialist platforms like We Work Remotely.

Tips to Succeed

Highlight communication skills in your resume

Emphasize any bilingual abilities

Create a quiet, professional home office

Be flexible with shift availability

Consider industries with year-round demand

Don't Leave Money on the Table

40 ways to get 'free' money in Canada through rebates, bonuses and money strategies

Let's go

1. *Become a Search Engine Evaluator*

Search engine evaluators are tasked with checking the quality and accuracy of search engine results. Sites like Appen, TELUS International and Clickworker are a good starting point when searching for jobs. Each task will come with specific instructions about what you need to do and the sort of feedback required to help search engines improve their algorithms and deliver a better user experience.

Tips to Succeed

Complete qualification exams carefully

Maintain high accuracy ratings

Be consistent with your work quality

Stay updated on search engine guidelines

Consider specializing in specific content areas

1. *Become a Dog Walker or Pet Sitter*

Turn your love of animals into a way to earn extra income by becoming a part-time or full-time dog walker. Sites and apps like Pawshake and Rover make it easy for you to advertise your walking services to dog owners in your area. You can also offer your services as a pet sitter, either in the pet owner's home or by hosting pets in your own home.

Tips to Succeed

Build trust through reviews and references

Get pet first aid certified

Take photos during walks to share with owners

Be reliable and communicate clearly

Consider offering additional services like grooming

1. *Sell Your Photos*

If you're a keen photographer and you'd like to potentially consider photography as an alternative career,

you might be able to make money online by selling your images to stock photo services. Sites like Dreamstime, iStock, 500px, Shutterstock and Alamy are just some of the popular stock image platforms where you might like to try your luck.

Tips to Succeed

Focus on niches with high demand

Submit high-quality, technically perfect images

Include relevant keywords and descriptions

Build a large portfolio for passive income

Track which images sell best and create more like them

1. *Sell Your Music Online*

Share your musical gifts with the world and sell your music online. Once you've recorded a few tracks, use a digital music distributor like DistroKid or TuneCore to get your music on streaming platforms like Spotify and in digital music stores. Alternatively, you can also upload your tunes to stock music libraries.

Tips to Succeed

Distribute to multiple streaming platforms

Promote your music on social media

License music to stock libraries for passive income

Collaborate with other artists for exposure

Build a fanbase through live performances

1. *Sell Your Art Online*

Painting, drawing, sculpture and more—there are many types of art you can sell online. You might like to set up your own online gallery or use a platform like Etsy or Gallea to sell individual physical works or digital downloads. Alternatively, you could use a print-on-demand service to sell prints of your work or get your designs featured on t-shirts, mugs, posters and much more.

Tips to Succeed

Develop a recognizable style

Photograph your work professionally

Price based on materials, time, and market rates

Promote on social media and art communities

Offer limited editions to create urgency

1. *Invest*

Last but not least, it's also possible to make money online by investing. The rise of online stock brokers and trading apps means that it's easier than ever before to trade stocks and ETFs on Canadian and US markets as well as exchanges around the world. Compare online stock brokers to find the best investing platform for your needs.

Tips to Succeed

Start with low-cost index funds or ETFs

Understand your risk tolerance

Diversify across asset classes

Invest consistently over time

Educate yourself continuously

1. ***Start a Newsletter***

Email newsletters have experienced a renaissance in recent years, with platforms like Substack, Beehiiv, and ConvertKit making it easy to build a paid audience. If you have expertise or a unique perspective on a topic, you can create a newsletter and charge subscribers for access to premium content.

Tips to Succeed

Choose a niche you can consistently write about

Publish on a regular schedule

Offer value in every issue

Build a free audience before introducing paid tiers

Promote through social media and cross-promotion

1. ***Become a Podcast Editor or Producer***

As the podcast industry continues to grow, there's increasing demand for skilled editors and producers. If you have audio editing skills, you can offer your services to podcasters who want to improve the quality of their shows. This can be done remotely and on a freelance basis.

Tips to Succeed

Master audio editing software like Audacity or Adobe Audition

Build a portfolio with sample edits

Offer packages for different levels of service

Network with podcasters in your niche

Consider offering launch services for new podcasts

What Are the Best Ways to Make Money Online in Canada?

There's no single, one-size-fits-all best way to make money online. The best option for you depends on the skills and tools at your disposal.

For example, renting out a spare room on Airbnb can be a reasonably simple way to supplement your income. Or, if you have the skills needed to work as a freelancer, whether as a copywriter, a web designer or anything else, you could turn your online money-making adventure into a full-time gig.

But if you don't have anything to sell or rent, and if you don't have any special skills or expertise, perhaps the easiest way to make money online is to complete online surveys. While it won't make you rich, anyone can do it and there are multiple platforms available where you can earn a little extra cash.

Matching Methods to Your Situation

Your Situation Best Options

No special skills Surveys, receipt scanning, cashback sites

Have unused items Selling possessions, renting out space

Creative skills Freelancing, print-on-demand, selling art

Professional skills Consulting, freelancing, online courses

Time but no money Surveys, game apps, AI training

Money to invest Investing, dropshipping, subscription boxes

Frequently Asked Questions

What are the easiest ways to make money online in Canada?

The easiest ways to make money online in Canada include completing paid surveys on platforms like Swagbucks and Prime Opinion, taking advantage of banking sign-up bonuses, selling unused items on

Facebook Marketplace or Kijiji, and using cashback websites for your regular shopping. These methods require minimal skills and low time investment, making them accessible to virtually anyone. However, they typically offer modest earnings that supplement rather than replace regular income.

How do I make money online without investment in Canada?

You can make money online without any upfront investment through several methods. Paid surveys require no investment and can be started immediately. Selling items you already own on marketplaces generates cash from unused possessions. Freelancing on platforms like Upwork and Fiverr requires only your skills and time. Cashback websites pay you for shopping you're already doing. Content creation through blogging, YouTube, or social media costs nothing but time to start. Teaching English online with platforms like Cambly requires only a native speaker level of English.

What are the fastest ways to make money online in Canada?

The fastest ways to make money online in Canada include selling items on Facebook Marketplace or Kijiji (cash within days), completing paid surveys with fast payout platforms like Prime Opinion and HeyCash (cash within hours), taking advantage of bank sign-up bonuses (payment within weeks), and freelancing on platforms like Fiverr (payment upon project completion). For immediate cash, selling unused possessions locally typically generates money fastest.

How much can I realistically earn from online work in Canada?

Earnings vary dramatically based on the method and your effort. Survey sites typically pay $5 to $100 per month for casual users. Freelancing can range from a few hundred dollars monthly as a side hustle to full-time income. Blogging and YouTube take months or years to generate significant income but can eventually replace a full-time salary. Dropshipping and e-commerce can be highly variable, from losses to six-figure incomes. Most online methods start as supplemental income before potentially growing into primary income.

Do I need to pay taxes on online income in Canada?

Yes, the Canada Revenue Agency (CRA) requires you to report all income from all sources, including online earnings. Whether you need to pay taxes depends on your total income and deductions. If you're earning significant amounts from online work, you should set aside a portion for taxes and consider consulting a tax professional. Keep detailed records of your earnings and expenses to maximize deductions and ensure compliance.

Which online money-making methods are best for beginners in Canada?

For complete beginners, paid surveys and cashback sites are the easiest starting points—they require no special skills and have low barriers to entry. Selling unused possessions is also beginner-friendly and generates quick cash. As you gain confidence, you can explore freelancing, content creation, or e-commerce. Starting with simple methods allows you to learn the basics of earning online before investing time in more complex ventures.

Bottom Line

There are more ways to make money online in Canada than ever before. Whether you're looking for a quick side hustle to supplement your income or a full-time career change, the options in this guide offer legitimate opportunities to earn money from the comfort of your home.

The key to success is matching your chosen method to your available time, skills, and resources. Start with something accessible, build your confidence and earnings, then expand into more lucrative opportunities as you gain experience.

Remember that legitimate online income requires effort—there's no such thing as free money. But with consistency and patience, the methods in this guide can help you achieve your financial goals, whether that's paying off debt, saving for a vacation, or building a new career.

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